

Preliminary Development and Validation of Multidimensional Rape Predisposition Scale

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Approval of Dissertation

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This is to certify that the dissertation submitted by Utkarsh Singh () titled, “Preliminary Development and Validation Of Multidimensional Rape Predisposition Scale” is a record of original research work done by him during the academic year 2022-2023 under my supervision in partial fulfilment for the award of the degree in Bachelor of Science in Psychology (Honours). This dissertation has not been submitted for the award of any other degree, diploma, associateship, fellowship or another title. It has not been sent for publication or presentation.

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Declaration

I, Utkarsh Singh, hereby declare that the dissertation titled, “Preliminary Development Of Multidimensional Rape Predisposition Scale” is a record of original research work undertaken by me for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Science in Psychology (Honours). I have completed this study under the supervision of Dr Rameshbabu Tamarana, Department of Psychology, CHRIST (Deemed to be University), Bangalore. I also declare that I am responsible for the work submitted in this dissertation, that the original work is my own except as specified in the acknowledgements, footnotes, or references, and that neither the dissertation nor the original work contained therein has been submitted to this or any other institution for a degree.

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Abstract

This study aimed to develop and validate the Multidimensional Rape Predisposition Scale (MRPS) to assess the multifaceted nature of rape predisposition among young adults. A total of 165 participants (aged 17-38 years; $M = 22.49$, $SD = 4.12$) completed the MRPS along with the Situational Rape Proclivity Scale (SRPS) and the Spritual transcendence Scale- Short Form (STS-R) ($N=109$) for convergent and discriminant validity assessment. Exploratory factor analysis (EFA) identified a five-factor model of the MRPS, comprising Affective Concern, Social Functioning, Need for Power, Responsibility Avoidance, and Consent Taking, accounting for 61.8% of the variance. The 17-item MRPS demonstrated good reliability with a Cronbach's alpha of .74. Convergent validity was supported by a positive correlation between the MRPS and SRPS ($r = .278$, $p < .01$), while discriminant validity was evidenced by a non-significant, low correlation between the MRPS and STS-R ($r = .038$, $p = .692$). The findings suggest that the MRPS is a reliable and valid measure of rape predisposition, capturing various dimensions that contribute to sexual aggression. Future research should employ confirmatory factor analysis and structural equation modeling to further validate the scale and explore the relationships among the identified factors. The development of targeted prevention and intervention strategies addressing the specific factors identified in the MRPS is also recommended.

Keywords: Rape Predisposition, Young Adults, Sexual Aggression, Scale

Development

Preliminary Development And Validation Of Multidimensional Rape Predisposition Scale

“Rape is one of the most terrible crimes on earth and it happens every few minutes. The problem with groups who deal with rape is that they try to educate women about how to defend themselves. What really needs to be done is teaching men not to rape. Go to the source and start there.”

— Kurt Cobain

Background

Sexual assault is amongst the most pressing issues in India and worldwide, significantly affecting the well-being and safety of the victims and those involved in their immediate environment. According to the most recent government report on crimes in the nation, India reported 31,677 occurrences of rape in 2021, or 86 per day on average, while there were approximately 49 incidences of violence against women reported every single hour. Rape cases decreased from 32,033 in 2019 to 28,046 in 2020, according to the National Crime Records Bureau's (NCRB) "Crime in India 2021" report. While not statistically proven, Delhi was widely known as the “Rape capital” of the world. After the “Nirbhaya” Rape case in 2012, some changes in laws were brought into place, but to little avail, as shown by the statistics displayed above. Cases like Hathras and Unnao still shake up the country’s heart and it is of the utmost urgency that academics also contribute to the identification, and intervention of risk factors to reduce the probability of such instances happening.

Sexual assault Risk assessment

Over time, extensive scientific and psychological scrutiny of sexual offenders has contributed to a deeper understanding of rape and sexual abuse. The research paper in question tries to integrate different models of sexual offending to develop a psychometric scale which can identify predispositions towards rape in young adult males which will allow for corrective interventions. Sex offender risk assessments are most often used in forensic settings for decision-making purposes (Doren, 2002), such decision is usually related to sentencing and criminal adjudications, determination of treatment needs, civil commitment proceedings and assessments of sexual recidivism.

Sex offender risk assessment has categorizations, which include Unstructured clinical assessment, structured clinical assessment, research-guided clinical judgment, pure actuarial approach and adjusted actuarial approach (Hanson, 1998). The study at hand tries to contribute to the Adjusted actuarial approach, In which existing actuarial instruments are used and then a finite list of considerations is used to evaluate the level of risk further.

There are multiple forms of risk factors that have been categorized as Static(Historical), dynamic(dispositional), Contextual, and clinical factors(Ward et al., 2005). Different generations of risk assessment have included different such factors and only recently have started to become multidimensional, with the focus shifting from static to dynamic factors. The advantage of an assessment of dynamic factors is that, firstly, they are changeable and can be intervened upon, secondly, they contribute incrementally to the ability of static factors in predicting reoffence(Eher et al., 2012; Nunes & Babchishin, 2012; Olver et al., 2014; Thornton & Knight, 2015). It is interesting to note that while dispositional factors have origins in developmental histories(static factors), they are always causally implicated in the onset of abusive behavior(Ward et al., 2005).

Focus on consent

The study therefore for its variables focuses primarily on dynamic factors(Need for power, empathetic concern, Immediate gratification) while taking into account contextual and clinical factors(Consent taking, Rape Myths, Emotional dysfunction, Social life).

It is also to be noted that According to research, nonverbal indications for consent are employed more frequently than spoken ones (Hickman & Muehlenhard, 1999; Orchowski et al., 2020; Righi et al., 2019). Qualitative data reveals that people are skilled communicators when it comes to sex, successfully interpreting their partners' hints and behaviors as readiness or refusal (Beres, 2014; O'Byrne et al., 2008). This is true despite the potential intricacy of nonverbal cues. People still acknowledge that verbal affirmation of consent tends to reduce uncertainty regarding their or their partner's willingness to engage in sexual activity, although many believe it to be inconsistent with cultural norms for sexual consent between partners (Burkett & Hamilton, 2012; Curtis & Burnett, 2017). (Righi et al., 2019).

This leads this paper to include consent taking as a primary variable, not taken in earlier scales. Consent-taking and cue-perception skills are common in normal populations. Consent, in current laws, forms a significant component when it comes to defining sexual assault, therefore deviance in consent-taking must be factored in.

Theoretical Framework

The scale takes five models of sexual offending into account, namely ITSO(Integrated Theory of sexual offending, (Ward et al, 2005), CMM(Confluence Mediation Model, Malamuth 2017), SRM(Self Regulation model), Generalist vs Specialist Model(Lussier, 2005), and The Feminist Framework Plus(McPhail, 2015).

Integrated theory of sexual offending

It is proposed in the integrated theory of sexual offending that there are three sets of components that interact continuously: biological factors, ecological niche factors, social, cultural, and personal situations, and neuropsychological factors. The biological factors are impacted by genetic inheritance and brain development. The hypothesis presented here states that sexual offenses result from a continuous confluence of distant and close influences that interact in a dynamic fashion. A substantial influence of social learning and genetic predispositions on brain development is the emergence of three interconnected neuropsychological systems (Pennington, 2002). It is further argued that the clinical issues seen in offenders, such as deviant arousal, offense-related thoughts and fantasies, negative/positive affective states, and social difficulties, are the result of interactions between genes, social learning, and neuropsychological systems. According to Figure 1, these state elements are what cause people to act in sexually abusive ways.

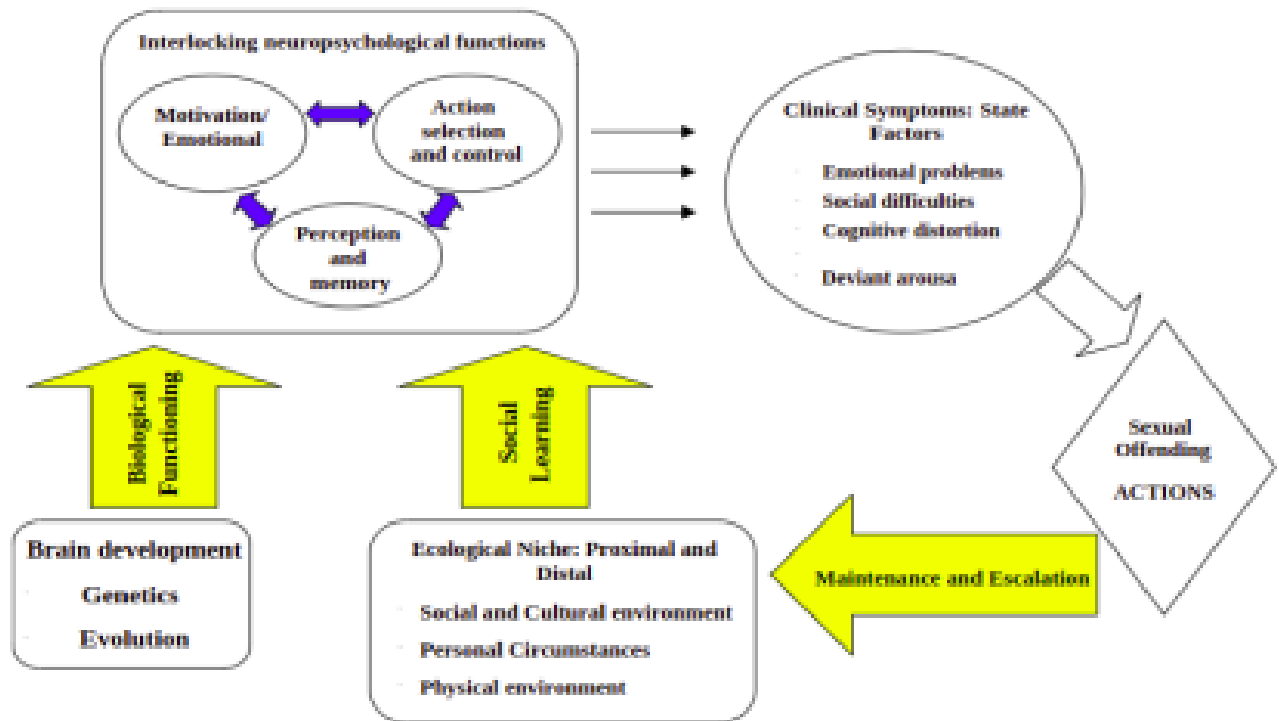
Figure 1*Integrated theory of sexual offending**T. Ward, A. Beech / Aggression and Violent Behavior 11 (2006) 44–63*

Fig. 1. Unified Theory of Sexual Offending.

Confluence Mediational Model

Proposed originally by Malamuth in 1986, The Confluence Model considers sexual aggression contextualized to developmental, personality, and behavioral factors, particularly in non-criminal male populations. After looking at such variables, it separated two clusters of interrelated variables, which are also independent of each other, namely, Impersonal Sex(IS) and

Hostile Masculinity(HM).

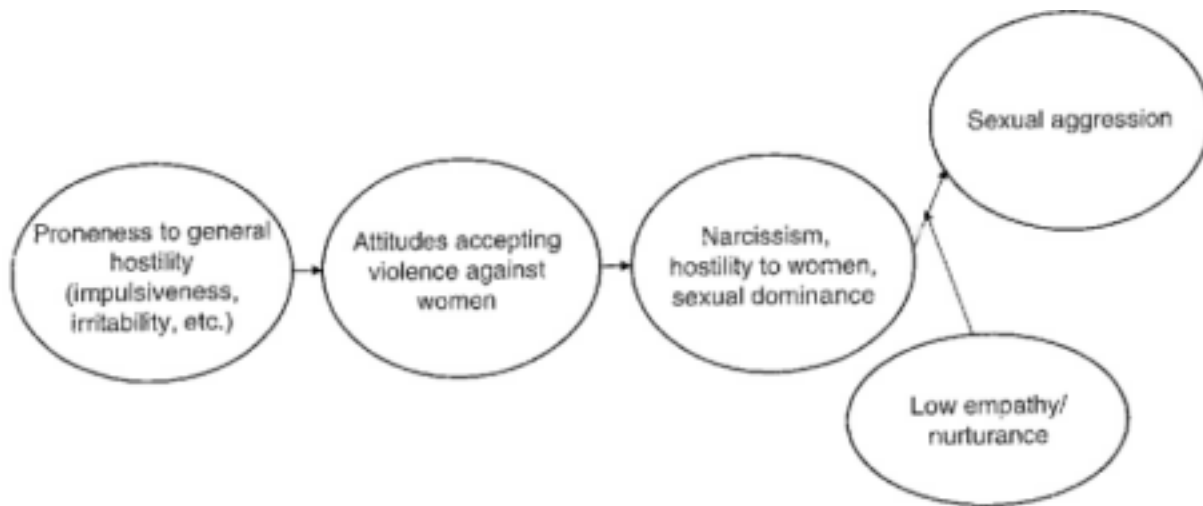
The HM aspect is a personality profile combining two aspects, a) A narcissistic, insecure, defensive, hypersensitive, and hostile-distrustful orientation, particularly towards women and b) Sexual gratification from controlling/dominating women.

The IS aspect is reflective of the developmental history of the individual, specifically in an abusive environment, leading to anti-social learning and a detached orientation towards sexual activities.

Empathy/nurturance is found to be an important mediating factor in this model.

Figure 2.

The Confluence Mediation Model Of Sexual Aggression(Malamuth,2017)



Self-Regulation Model

According to the self-regulation model (SRM), sexual abusers have goal-directed

behavior towards the desired state, either to satisfy or avoid offending(Debaca et al, 2015).

According to the paradigm, there are four routes that result in sexual offense. Offenders who make an effort to refrain from offending (avoidance oriented) but do not have sufficient tactics (i.e., they have either underregulated or misregulated self-control) to refrain from undesirable conduct fall into two categories (the sexual offense). The two other paths describe people who are approach-oriented and want to feel good as a consequence of achieving goals connected to sexual offenses. The validity of the model and its application to categorization and therapy are supported by research on SRM.

It has been demonstrated that SRM pathways can distinguish between offensive characteristics and static and dynamic risk.

Rapists are more likely to follow the approach-automatic pathway because their goal is to offend, but they offend impulsively to situational cues (Yates, Kingston, & Hall, 2003).

Specialist VS Generalist Model

According to the specialist vs. generalist concept, sexual offenders may be divided into two groups: those who consistently commit sexual offenses as specialists or those who commit offenses of all kinds (Lussier, 2005). According to the generalist view, criminal behavior includes a wide range of acts that are signs of impulsivity and poor self-control (Gottfredson & Hirschi, 1990). It has been found that Rapists generally follow the generalist model, unlike child abusers.

The Feminist Framework Plus model

The FF is created by combining five feminist theories, as listed in Fig3. As can be seen in the table, each of the five theories is given a name, the names of any notable theorists who

contributed to it, the underlying feminist theory, a summary of its main premises, and a representational graphic. Five main ideas follow naturally from the FF. The first idea is the recognition of rape as a sexual act performed on and by particular bodies, with sexual repercussions for the victim. Rape falls along the same spectrum as normative heterosexuality in terms of sexual acts, with a concentration on male sexual dominance and female sexual submission.

The second key idea is the recognition that numerous reasons, as opposed to only the desire for power or control, can lead to rape. Sexual fulfillment, vengeance, recreation, power/control, and efforts to acquire or display masculinity are just a few of the varied motives. Power/control is still a key element in rape, but it may also be the reason, the method, or the outcome.

Thirdly, The theory recognises rape as both a highly personal, intimate act in which one person's body is violated by another and as a political, collective act in which males as a group rule and control women as a group (s).

Figure 3

Feminist Framework Plus(McPhail, B. A. (2016). Feminist Framework Plus: Knitting Feminist Theories of Rape Etiology Into a Comprehensive Model.)

Table 1. Feminist Framework Plus: Theory-Knitting a Feminist Model of Sexual Assault Etiology.

Row	Title	Patriarchal Power and Control	Normative Heterosexuality	At the Intersections	Doing Masculinity, Doing Rape	Embodied Sexual Practice
1	Feminist perspective	Radical/liberal	Radical ²	Women of Color/ Intersectionality	Social construction	Postmodern/Queer/French
2	Primary theorist(s)	New York Radical Feminists & Susan Brownmiller	Catherine MacKinnon	Angela Davis & Kimberlé Crenshaw	Diana Scully, Anne Cossins, James Messerschmidt	Ann Cahill
3	Theory premise	Rape is a political act due to motives of power/control in order to preserve male domination and female subordination.	Rape is a continuation of normative heterosexuality where violence is eroticized and female subjugation ensured.	Rape occurs at the interactional nexus of race, class, gender, and other identities with unique consequences for women of color and others at intersections.	Rape is a way for men to achieve masculinity; thus, motives are multiple.	Rape is a sexually specific act upon the body/self; bodies are different, so rape is specific –the specific bodies and relationships matter.
4	Graphic representation					
5	Theoretical overlap	Relations of power, cultural/patriarchal influences, gender dynamics, feminist perspective				
6	Empirically-derived gender factors	Sexual entitlement, hostility towards women, belief in rape myths and traditional gender roles, emphasized heterosexuality, existence of patriarchy and gender inequality				
7	Additional level of Analysis	Historical	Interactional	Historical	Interactional	Individual
8	Plus	Empirically derived individual risk factors for sexual assault (compiled from bibliographic sources)				
	Psychological	Low self-esteem, low-empathy, subclinical psychopathic traits, deviant sexual arousal and scripts, poor mental health, deviant fantasy, cognitive distortions				
	Environmental	Childhood abuse (sexual & physical), parental intimate partner violence				
	Developmental	Attachment disorders, early sexual initiation, peer pressure, intimacy deficits				
	Situational	Alcohol & drug use/misuse, firearms, gang membership, juvenile delinquency, multiple sexual partners				
	Biological	Genetic factors, Gene × Environmental factors, androgens, neurological deficits				

Variables

Based on these models, six variables, namely Consent taking, Rape Myth Support, Need for Power, Empathetic concern, Immediate Gratification, and Socio-Emotive Functioning(emotional

regulation, social Functioning), were selected. These are reflective of the social, emotional, cognitive, and motivational factors present in the context of an individual, a combination of which is hypothesised in this study to predispose them towards committing rape.

These variables, which can be separated into risk and protective factors, if validated, can help in developing multidimensional interventions, which will protect potential victims and perpetrators alike from the consequences of such an act taking place.

Consent taking

The willingness of individuals to partake in partnered sexual activity is referred to as sexual consent. Usually, one person begins or asks for sexual activity, and the other person reacts according to how willing they are to partake in that activity (Muehlenhard et al., 2016). A consensual sexual experience might be the culmination of this process of sexual consent, which can be iterative (Beres, 2014; Humphreys, 2004; Willis & Jozkowski, 2021). It must have the below-mentioned components-

- Freely given. Consenting is a choice you make without pressure, manipulation, or under the influence of drugs or alcohol.
- Reversible. Anyone can change their mind about what they feel like doing, anytime. Even if they have done it before, and even if they are both naked in bed.
- Informed. One can only consent to something if one has the full story. For example, if someone says they will use a condom and then they do not, there is no full consent.

- Enthusiastic. When it comes to sex, one must only engage in activities one wants to do, not things that one feels they are expected to do.
- Specific. Saying yes to one thing (like going to the bedroom to make out) does not mean they have said yes to others (like having sex).

Rape Myths

Rape myths are the commonly accepted term for attitudes that are rape-tolerant or rape-supportive. Rape myths, according to Burt (1980), are prejudiced and stereotypical ideas concerning rape and the circumstances in which it occurs. Someone who harbours rape myths explains or excuses sexually violent behaviour and frequently places the blame on the victim. Therefore, adopting attitudes and ideas that promote or tolerate rape is crucial in maintaining a sexually aggressive person's behaviour. As a result, rape-myth acceptance assessment is crucial for understanding the mentality of sexually aggressive men and for evaluating their level of approval for such ideas.

The Rape Myths in the scale will cover the Given dimensions, Extracted from the Rape Attitudes and Beliefs Scale(Burgess, 2007)-

1. Not Rape (denial that acquaintance rape is real and causes trauma to the victim), This dimension is retained as it is.
2. Women Cause (Placing the responsibility of sexual assault on women), this dimension is revised as Survivor Cause
3. Alcohol (problematic attitudes and beliefs about mixing alcohol use and sexual activity). This dimension is retained as it is.
4. Transphobia (general hostility faced by transgender individuals) and Transmisogyny

(Serano, 2007) (general hostility towards women and feminine qualities). Transmisogyny is misogyny faced by transgender women and transfeminine people. This differs from traditional misogyny because it is faced particularly by people at the feminine end of the gender spectrum but who have not necessarily been assigned female at birth. This dimension is named Transphobia & misogyny and is an additional dimension.

5. Gender role (acceptance of traditional male and female gender roles)- Traditional sexism is the belief (held by the perpetrator) that femaleness and femininity are inferior to and exist for the benefit of maleness and masculinity. (Serano, 2007). Traditional sexism serves to delegitimize women and femininity while oppositional sexism serves to delegitimize gender non-conformity.

Need For Power

A motivational trait known as the need for power is the desire to enjoy having an impact on others or the environment in general and to dislike having others' influence on oneself. The need for power (nPower) is one of the three fundamental types of human motivation, according to McClelland (1961). (along with the need for achievement and the need for affiliation). Personalized (pPower) and socialized motives can be seen as two distinct types of power motivation (sPower; e.g., McClelland 1970, 1975, Winter 1973). Personal power and societal power have similar aspirations to exert influence over others, but they have different outcomes.

Empathic Concern

According to Davis(1980), Empathic Concern forms the emotional component of the construct of empathy, and assesses the feelings of warmth, compassion and concern for another

individual. In contemporary literature, Empathy has been divided into three components, Empathic Concern forms the emotional component, which also is reflective of perspective-taking (Cognitive empathy), which usually precedes EC.

Immediate Gratification

Instant (or immediate) gratification is a term that refers to the temptation, and resulting tendency, to forego a future benefit in order to obtain a less rewarding but more immediate benefit (Ackerman, 2018). Impulsivity, a central trait found amongst offenders in the theories aforementioned, is highly correlated with a compulsion for immediate gratification (Gaik et al., 2015).

Socio-Emotive Functioning

An Individual's Emotional regulation and social life are considered under Socio-Emotive Functioning here. Dysregulation, sometimes referred to as emotional dysregulation, is the inability to control one's emotional emotions or to maintain them within a range that is appropriate for regular emotional reactions. This phrase may be used to describe a variety of feelings, such as grief, rage, irritation, and annoyance.

The capacity to create, nurture, and maintain significant social relationships is referred to as social functioning. To evaluate health-related restrictions in routine or regular social activities, a social activity limitations assessment might be utilized (Sherbourne, 1992).

Review of Literature

Consent

The concerned variables, affect our study through different dimensions, with most having much theoretical research work already done, other than consent taking as a construct which, has only been considered as a subset of Rape Myth acceptance scales.

Section 90 of the Indian penal code has clear definitions for what is NOT consent, It is as follows-

- Consent known to be given under fear or misconception.—A consent is not such a consent as it intended by any section of this Code if the consent is given by a person under fear of injury, or under a misconception of fact, and if the person doing the act knows, or has reason to believe, that the consent was given in consequence of such fear or misconception;
- Consent of insane person.—if the consent is given by a person who, from unsoundness of mind, or intoxication, is unable to understand the nature and consequence of that to which he gives his consent;
- Consent of child.—unless the contrary appears from the context if the consent is given by a person who is under twelve years of age.
- The Nirbhaya Act or Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013 defines consent as the unequivocal voluntary agreement to participate in a sexual act. This means there needs to be a clear expression of willingness to participate. The act further clarifies that the absence of resistance will not imply consent.

This means that consent does not have to be spoken and there is no need for her to say no explicitly. Women can show the lack of consent through other ways, such as gestures. There is no room for argument when it comes to consent; it is black or white. A woman's consent must be verified by the partner; they cannot assume it. Consent is crucial for all types of sexual activity, including that which occurs online as well as in person. Without a woman's permission, no one has the right to send her sexually explicit texts or images. The same is true of consent; it can be revoked at any time after being given. A lady is capable of initially answering "yes" and later "no."

This definition inherently demands the understanding of both, consent as a concept, and sound situational awareness and interpretation for its application in variable environments. This makes consent taking a cognitive task as a process, making use of heuristics, perception, interpretation, and decision-making (Northoff, 2006). This forms the perception and memory component in the Interlocking neuropsychological components of the ITSO, and attitudes aspect of the CMM.

Undergraduate men, and especially those supporting greater RSA(Rape Supportive attitudes), dramatically overestimated how much the average college male viewed increasing nonconsensual activity as justifiable. This error was closely associated with three cognitive processes. These results highlight the value of combining research on social norms and cognitive processing to document perspective's overall impact on average justifiability judgments as well as its impact on the cognitive processes that underlie the ratings(Viken et al, 2022).

This is why, a distinction between the Cognitive component (Consent taking), Has been made from the Rape Myths variable in the paper, which forms the social component.

Rape Myths

Rape myths (RMs) are a complex collection of cultural attitudes and beliefs that encourage and excuse sexual violence, primarily by putting the onus of responsibility on the victim rather than the offender. Research shows that people who have higher rape myth acceptance (RMA) are less likely to believe victims of sexual assault, report their own assault if victimised, and are at an increased risk for sexual violence perpetration. Much empirical attention has been paid to how RMs perpetuate cultural norms that justify sexually assaultive behaviours.(Zidenberg et al, 2021)

Education about the socialization of men has value on its own (Burgess, 2002; Stevens, 2001), but it is also possible to explore and develop a broader definition of manhood with men individually, one that is supportive of positive and equal relationships with women and other genders and unrelated to one's sexuality or sexual exploitation.

A belief in rape myths as an essential component of the potential offender psyche is supported by all the overarching theories considered in the study, forming the social learning, and felicitation aspect, while also influencing potential perpetrators' attitudes at large.

Sometimes ecological niches rather than individuals are the main sources of causes for sexual offense. The behavior may be highly opportunistic or the result of circumstances that seriously impair a person's ability to act in an ethical and customary manner (see Marshall & Barbaree, 1990). When we take these things into account, we can see that sexual misconduct is not just a result of personal psychopathology, but rather results from a network of relationships between persons and their local habitats and niches.

The following three variables are of a more personal nature and can be termed traits. Although trait theorists have claimed that these psychological issues (i.e.traits) are a result of

neuropsychological processes, in their current iterations they are only useful labels that may be applied to characterize a person's functioning(Ward & Beech, 2005).

Need for power

Feminist perspectives point to power as a motivation for committing sexual assault (Brownmiller, 1975; Burt, 1980; Lonsway and Fitzgerald, 1994). The hostile Masculinity component of the CMM clearly states sexual dominance and the need for power as one of its major components, which might predispose someone towards using force for the attainment of sex. Davis, 1981, notes that Because powerful men feel that because they are males they have the right to rape women, while working-class men are offered rape as compensation for their lack of power, the class structure of capitalism is seen as providing incentives to rape. According to Scully and Marolla (1985), there are a variety of reasons why men rape, including retaliation and/or punishment (against a specific woman, a group of women, or revenge against a man), sexual access to unwilling or unavailable women, sexual conquest, a desire for impersonal sex the fulfilment of a rape fantasy, a form of recreation or adventure, the pursuit of a challenge, power, control, and dominance, in order to prove one's masculinity.

This is supported by Sanday's (1981) landmark study on the subject since it was able to discriminate between "rape-prone" and "rape-free" civilizations. She discovered that rape-prone civilizations were linked to interpersonal violence, male social dominance, and the subjection of women in her cross-cultural research of 95 tribal and band groups. The absence of interpersonal violence and respect for female leadership and decision-making, on the other hand, were hallmarks of rape-free communities. The need for power can be accommodated by the motivational/emotional

component of the ITSO.

Empathetic Concern

Empathy forms a major mediational role in the Confluence Mediational model. However, in general, it is thought that empathy is a complicated, multifaceted concept made up of a number of different elements, including perspective-taking, empathetic concern, and personal distress (Davis, 1980). Personal distress is the experience of negative sentiments after observing another person in difficulty, as opposed to empathic concern, which is the individual's other-oriented feelings of sympathy and worry for someone in trouble (Davis, 1980, 1983).

Perspective-taking is the cognitive component, almost always precedes Empathetic concern. It has been widely documented that outward empathic concern is correlated to prosocial behavior (Batson et al., 1981). According to Batson et al. (1981), in a sample of undergraduate students, helping behavior varied according to the level of empathic concern they felt and the "ease of escape" or the cost to the subject of not assisting the person in need. The helping conduct of participants with high levels of empathic feeling was shown to be unaffected by the ease of escape, showing that their motivation was entirely altruistic and centered on relieving the victim's suffering. Similarly, anti-social behavior has been correlated with low empathy, and also with a high propensity toward violence, which includes that of sexual nature. Rapists are less empathic than nonrapists, and deviant arousal has been negatively correlated with self-reported empathy, which is consistent with the lack of empathy explanation of rape (Rice et al, 1994).

Immediate Gratification

The Immediate Gratification variable is accommodated by the action selection & control component of the ITSO and is closely related to impulsivity, which has been documented to be a central trait in sexual offenders and people with violent tendencies alike. In general, characterological, cognitive, and behavioral viewpoints can be used to categorize how professionals use the term "impulsivity." Ordinary people's use of impulsivity, as Arce and Santisteban pointed out, is comparable to Eysenck's characterological viewpoint. Impulsivity, according to Eysenck, is the inclination to act without thinking things through, take risks, and make decisions rapidly. On the other hand, impulsivity is attempted to be viewed from a behavioral and cognitive standpoint as the simple antithesis of self-control. These viewpoints claim that impulsivity is the inability to delay gratification. Therefore, in this sense, the term "immediate gratification" can be more accurately used to describe impulsivity(Dawd, 2017).

According to the specialist vs generalist model mentioned before, criminal behavior includes a wide range of acts that are signs of impulsivity and poor self-control (Gottfredson & Hirschi, 1990). It has been found that Rapists generally follow the generalist model. The self-regulation model of sexual offending also suggests that Rapists are more likely to follow the approach-automatic pathway because their goal is to offend, but they offend impulsively to situational cues (Yates, Kingston, & Hall, 2003). Impulsivity has distinguished perpetrators from non-perpetrators. Perpetrators scored higher than non-perpetrators on Negative Urgency, Positive Urgency, and lack of Premeditation. Studies suggest that the impulsivity traits most relevant to sexual aggression are the tendency to act impulsively when experiencing intense emotions (Positive and Negative Urgency) and lack of forethought and planning (lack of Premeditation)(Mouilso et al, 2013).

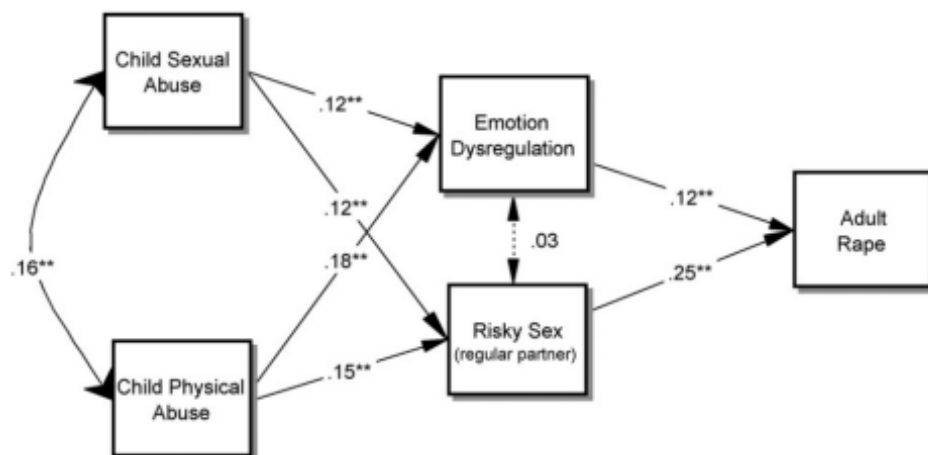
Socio-Emotive Functioning

This leads us to our final variable which is Socio-Emotive Functioning and has two sub-components, namely Social Functioning measuring emotional dysregulation and social functioning.

The ability to regulate emotions is known to be negatively impacted by childhood abuse, and psychological problems are more susceptible to those who lack effective emotion regulation skills. According to Shields and Cicchetti (1998), emotional dysregulation frequently starts in childhood and lasts into adolescence and adulthood (Kilpatrick et al., 2003). Adaptive emotion regulation emphasizes awareness and understanding of emotions, while certain conceptualizations of emotion regulation place more emphasis on controlling emotional experience and expression (particularly of negative emotional states) (Thompson & Calkins, 1996). According to Hayes, Wilson, Gifford, Follette, and Strosahl (1996), attempts to suppress internal experiences, such as emotional experiences, are inherently harmful to psychological functioning and may be the root cause of many psychological disorders. This phenomenon is known as experiential avoidance.

Figure. 4.

Model examining emotion dysregulation and risky sex with a regular partner as correlated intervening variables in the association between maltreatment and rape. (Moore et al, 2010)



Lemieux and Byers (2008) and Himelein et al. (1994) found that hazardous sexual conduct is a significant risk factor for re-victimization. The study by Moore et al. supports these findings. It's interesting to note that whereas child abuse was only linked to dangerous sexual behaviour with a regular dating partner, *emotion dysregulation* was linked to both number of sexual partners and dangerous sexual conduct with a stranger. Further, the study suggests that a clinical intervention aiming at treating emotion dysregulation may assist in lower hazardous sexual behavior and the likelihood of revictimization, as they demonstrate that emotion dysregulation is a significant gateway to more proximal risk factors like risky sexual conduct.

According to Marshall (1989), men who sexually abuse minors frequently lack the confidence and social skills needed to establish healthy personal relationships with peers. They become frustrated by their failure and seek out connections with youthful companions (Marshall, 1989; Marshall and Marshall, 2000).

Two studies by Seidman and colleagues (1994) focused on sex offenders' interpersonal issues and feelings of loneliness.

These studies show that social skills inadequacies among sex offenders severely limit the chances of sustaining intimacy. In Ward and Siegert's pathways model, The pathway of antisocial cognition is mentioned which includes attitudes and convictions that encourage criminal activity. These criminals have an antisocial lifestyle, exhibit a strong feeling of entitlement, and show little consideration for the psychological and emotional needs of others. They frequently support societal ideals that are in line with their criminal behavior.

All these variables together try to account for the strengths and weaknesses of the

overarching theories considered for the study and can be accommodated in each theory.

The rationale of the study

Existing literature about scales that currently exist and are used has been developed in two directions. Most scales are either to assess sexual recidivism amongst offenders(Baldwin, 2015) or to assess violence against women(Flood, 2008). It has been seen that so many actuarial static risk assessments have comparable predictive power because the amount of risk variability that can be forecasted solely using static components has hit an asymptotic limit. This opens the door for the inclusion of additional risk-related traits and variables, such as dynamic factors, treatment outcomes, the inclusion of strengths and protective variables, and variables predicting desistance. This broader, more comprehensive approach will better capture the complexity of human behavior.

The focus on multi-dimensional dynamic factors, therefore, covers three distinct research gaps from the previous studies-

- Existence of mostly unidimensional actuarial scales
- Reliance on single theoretical background for the development of scales
- Reliance on only capturing static factors

Furthermore, The study takes data specifically from the Indian young adult male population. This will further the research on sexual offenses and involved variables in the given demographic, which earlier studies have not studied in depth. Finally, the study also tries to

incorporate individuals from the LGBTQ community as potential victims, by being more inclusive in the language.

Significance and Scope of the Study

Chapter XVI, sections 375 to 377 of the IPC(Indian Penal Code), 1860 deals with sex-related offenses. As stated by Section 375, Indian Penal Code, A man is said to commit rape if he penetrates his penis to any extent into the vagina, mouth, urethra or anus of a woman or inserts any object, to any extent, or any part of a body other than the penis into the vagina, urethra and anus of a woman or put in his mouth into the vagina, urethra or anus of a woman or makes her do so with him or any other person, under the circumstances falling under the following descriptions:

- Opposed to her will.
- In the absence of her consent.
- With consent when it has been acquired by putting her or any other person related to her under the fright of death or hurt.
- Consent was obtained under the misconception of the fact that the man was the person, to whom she was lawfully married.
- When consent is given because of unsoundness of mind or intoxication of any stupefying or unwholesome substance.
- When the girl is a minor, no matter whether consent is given or not.
- When she is not able to provide her consent.

After the abolishment of Article 377, the act of intercourse amongst LGBTQ people was decriminalized, which leaves their protection in the context of the above-mentioned law still unclear, and subject to questioning. Sexual offenses against the LGBTQ community are far too common yet

are unrecognized in India because of the above-mentioned definitions. A survey conducted on the US population found that 45% of lesbians, 61% of bisexual women, 37% of bisexual men, and 26% of gay men had experienced rape, physical violence or stalking.

With the fact that such forms of sexual offenses exist, the need to research them further, identifying the common biological, cognitive, emotional, and social contributors leading to such behavior is all the more important. This, while promoting inclusivity, both in terms of identification and protection of potential perpetrators and victims, will help in making better general interventions for people with such predispositions.

The existing models of sexual violence have only taken male populations into account, therefore trying to generalise such traits across potential perpetrators is beyond the scope of this study, yet, an attempt at widening the scope of existing models in terms of potential victims is possible via the usage of non-binary language and also specific measurements.

Therefore, the scale to be developed integrates findings of different models and tries to account for a gender-diverse pool of potential victims, while still positioning males, in young adulthood, as potential perpetrators. These variables, which are considered risk factors in the study, if validated, can help in developing multidimensional interventions, which will protect potential victims and perpetrators alike from the consequences of such an act taking place.

The motive of the scale is to not label individuals as potential perpetrators but to look at the existence of certain factors within people which increase their likelihood of making sexually offensive choices in different situations, under normal circumstances (War and other non-normal ecological environments have been documented to override normal predispositions, Ward et al, 2005). The scale also does not attempt to look at the origin of the predisposition, but to identify its

existence, to provide intervention. The study also makes a clear distinction between consent-taking and rape myths understanding the former to be a perception and cognition-based factor, that provides for the heuristical basis of cue perception, whereas the latter is a social factor.

Most importantly, it is understood that the study focuses on Indian young adult males and their predisposition toward rape as an act since there are multiple forms of sexual offences which may have different dynamics.

Methods

Objective

This cross-sectional study was aimed at developing and preliminarily validating a multidimensional psychometric scale extracting literature from multiple models of sexual offending and testing for its applicability in the Indian context.

Research Design

Qualitative approaches were used, particularly for item production, item analysis, and establishing content validity in general. Two further scales were chosen and utilized to assess the proposed scale's criteria and discriminant validity. The data were mostly analyzed using principal factor analysis (FA). A cross-sectional research method collects data at a single point in time and enables the examination of the relationship between multiple variables because information may be gathered concurrently (Polit et al., 2001). This method has been shown to be the most efficient method of testing and validating a measurement tool (CEBMH, 2002).

Operational Definitions

Sexual Offense

Sexual offenses mean any form of unwanted sexual activity on physical, intellectual or mental degree of consciousness leading to invasion of private space, suppression of will, infliction of pain, and making the victim feel harassed.

Rape

As stated in section 375 of the IPC, a man is said to commit rape in the following instances:

- When he penetrates his penis to any extent into the vagina, mouth, urethra, or anus of a female.
- When he puts any object or any part of his body into the vagina, urethra, or anus of a woman.
- When he puts his mouth into the vagina, urethra or anus of a woman or forcibly makes her do so with him or any other person.

The section further says that penetration and insertion of objects can be “to any extent” including even slight and partial. Physical injuries to the private parts of the woman are not essential for rape.

Consent

Consent is an unequivocal voluntary agreement when a person communicates a willingness to engage in a specific sexual act through words, gestures, or any other means of verbal or nonverbal communication.

Rape Myth

Rape Myths are collective sets of attitudes and ideas that are rape tolerant and supportive, and contain elements of shifting the blame on the victim, Not believing certain acts such as acquaintance rape is rape, belief in strict unequal gender roles and general attitudes of hostility towards a gender not similar to oneself.

Need for power

The need for power is a form of motivation that stems from the want of dominating others and having influence.

Empathetic Concern

Empathetic Concern is the feeling of warmth, compassion and concern for another individual, which allows us to care for other individuals and extend our sense of self towards them.

Immediate Gratification

Immediate Gratification is the need to attain satisfaction, be it of a very small degree, in a very short span of time without any want of delaying the satisfaction for any other goal that does not

directly and immediately satiate the individual

Socio-Emotive Functioning

Socio-Emotive Functioning is the degree to which an individual is able to regulate their emotions in personal and social contexts and is able to interact with other individuals in a secure and functional manner.

Sample

The Participants were Indian male young adults between the ages of 18-30. According to Viswanathan (2005, p.70), "Convenience sampling, rather than probabilistic sampling, is suited for these studies because the goal is not to establish population estimates, but rather to use correlational analysis to examine relationships between items and measures."

The sample size was primarily determined by best practices in factor analysis guidelines, specifically a "participant to variable" ratio of 5 to 1 and a minimum of 100 subjects (Gorsuch, 1983), as well as a "coefficient of 46 overdetermination" (item to factor ratio) of 3 to 7 (MacCallum et al., 1999).

Respondents' Background Characteristics

A total of 165 participants responded to the study, with ages ranging from 17 to 38 years ($M = 22.49$, $SD = 4.12$). The age distribution was diverse, with the majority of participants falling between 18 and 21 years old. In terms of sexual experience, the sample was divided into three categories: never (35.2%, $n = 74$), at least once (20%, $n = 33$), and frequently (44.8%, $n = 58$).

Regarding participants' educational or work fields, 15.8% (n = 59) were in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics), 29.7% (n = 31) were in business, 18.8% (n = 49) were in social sciences (e.g., economics, psychology), and 35.8% (n = 26) were in humanities and languages. The participants' backgrounds were diverse, reflecting a range of academic and professional interests.

Finally, the study examined the locality where participants grew up. The majority (75.8%, n = 32) were from semi-urban areas, 19.4% (n = 125) were from urban areas, and 4.8% (n = 8) were from rural areas. This distribution suggests that the sample was predominantly composed of individuals from semi-urban and urban environments.

Table 1

Background Characteristics of Participants (N = 165)

Variable	Categories	Number Responses (n)	Percentage
Sexual Experience	Never	74	35.2%
	At least once	33	20.0%
	Frequently	58	44.8%

Educational/ Work Field	STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, Mathematics)	59	15.8%
	Business	31	29.7%
	Social Sciences (Economics, Psychology)	49	18.8%
	Humanities & Languages	26	35.8%
Grew up in Locality	Urban	125	19.4%
	Semi-Urban	32	75.8%
	Rural	8	4.8%

Only 162 respondents from the age group 18-30 were included for further analysis.

Procedure

The scale development procedure followed accepted and widely cited suggestions from meta-review papers(Kyriazos, T. A., & Stalikas, A. (2018)) & Serena Carpenter (2018) Ten Steps in Scale Development and Reporting: A Guide for Researchers, Communication Methods and Measures).

The Study followed a ten-step approach as suggested by Carpenter(2018), keeping in mind the feasibility of each step.

Step 1: Review of literature and establish the meaning and breadth of the theoretical concept. This includes a selection of appropriate labels, Identification of dimensions, Item writing, and expert reviews on items.

Step 2: Determination of sampling procedure

Step 3: Examination of data quality

Step 4: Verification of factorability of data

Step 5: Conduction of common factor analysis

Step 6: Selection of Factor Extraction Method

Step 7: Determination of the number of factors

Step 8: Factor Rotation

Step 9: Retaining and deleting factors based on a priori criteria

Step 10: Presenting results

Development of the Instrument

The original draft of the questionnaire included 54 items generated to represent the 6 factors initially conceptualized, as follows: (1) Consent (2) Rape Myth Acceptance (3) Need For

Power (4) Empathetic Concern (5) Immediate Gratification (6) Socio-Emotional Functioning The domains and dimensions indicated above were obtained from a review of the existing literature.

9 Items were written for each variable, while every care was taken to write clear and concise items and to avoid colloquial language (Lonsway & Fitzgerald, 1994).

. College teachers from education, health sciences, psychology, and statistics, and did item analysis and provided qualitative feedback. In general, objects were added, rearranged, or removed based on consensus. Face validity, salience, clarity, readability, theoretical relevance, and redundancy were all evaluated for all items.

The scores were measured on a six-point Likert scale, with no neutral answers(Strongly agree, Agree Somewhat agree, Somewhat disagree, Disagree, Strongly disagree). No neutral response was forced in order to sample attitudes towards questions where the participant might try to hide their true attitude, due to the sensitivity of the issue. Due to ambivalence, people frequently choose neutral options. Bishop (1987) showed that because people wish to escape the negative emotions brought on by their contradictory thoughts about a subject, they tend to respond neutrally in public opinion polls. Choosing a neutral option also spares people the cognitive effort required to decide between their positive and negative feelings regarding a subject (Nowlis et al., 2008).

Higher scores indicate a higher proclivity to rape. Six point scale is being chosen as Lozano, Garcia-Cueto, & Muniz (2008) suggested that reliability increases when there are more points.

The scale was accompanied by Rape Proclivity Scale (SRPS). The seven items included in this instrument were adapted from Malamuth's (1981) scale to assess men's proclivity to —have sex with a woman against her wishes in various situations, given —the assurance of no penalty or

consequence. Responses were coded on a 4-point scale, as either 1=Not at all likely, 2=Possible, but not likely, 3=Fairly likely, and 4=Very likely. Higher scores indicate a greater proclivity to rape.

Spiritual Transcendence Scale- Short Form(Ralph L. Piedmont, Ph.D., 2003) was used for testing for divergent validity. 17 Items were selected for final data analysis.

Table 2

Items from the Multidimensional Rape Proclivity Scale

Scale Items	
Question	Question Statement
Q1	It is okay to convince and persuade someone to have sex with me
Q2	If a person is not resisting sex it means that they want to have sex
Q3	It is okay to convince someone to try new things in sex
Q4	If a person is comfortable sharing a private room with me, I can have sex with them
Q5	People get raped because of their own behaviour/attitude
Q6	People who do not dress the way they should deserve to face the consequences
Q7	Authority over my sexual partner makes me satisfied

Q8	Having authority makes me feel superior to my sexual partner
Q9	It is important that my sexual partner remembers who is in charge
Q10	I feel sad when I hurt someone
Q11	I get affected by the emotions of people around me
Q12	I feel hurt when I see injustice
Q13	My friend's issues affect me emotionally
Q14	I feel lonely and isolated
Q15	Other people do not understand me
Q16	It is difficult to make deeper connections with people
Q17	It is difficult to find a sexual partner

Data Collection

The questionnaire was constructed in Google Forms, with each item or question allowing only one selection. There were 54 closed-ended items from the MRPS, as well as extra questions from the accompanying scales. The link to the questionnaire was included in an email invitation to participate, and before viewing the questionnaire, respondents had to view (and read) the online informed consent (Appendix E) and agree to participate. The data was collected between January and February of 2023.

Ethical Considerations

The participants were told that their participation in the current study was voluntary and that this topic is sensitive and may be offensive to some. The students' confidentiality and anonymity were ensured, and they were asked not to include any identifying information on the response form, email collection was not mandated. The men were told that they will have additional items to complete (i.e., the SRPS & STS-R), and they will be forewarned that these items will be more personal, but that again if they agree to complete it with sincerity, their confidentiality and anonymity would be ensured. Participants who agree to take the instruments can take as much time as they need to complete the scales.

Access to responses will strictly be limited to the researcher.

Data Analysis

The data analysis revolved around the assessment of the structural (underlying factors or subscales) and psychometric (reliability and validity) properties of the scale. The conventional methods were performed using exploratory factor analysis. The determination of if factor analysis should be used on the data, was done by looking at the correlation matrix, Bartlett's test of sphericity, and Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin (KMO). Before moving on to factor analysis, it is advised that the correlation matrix should contain numbers at levels of .30 or higher, Bartlett's chi-square should be significant at a probability of .05 or less, and a KMO value of .60 or higher (McCrosky & Young, 1979; Pett et al., 2003; Tabachnick & Fidell, 2007) should be present.

After determining if the data is fit for factor analysis, Exploratory factor analysis was used to look for latent variables.

Determining the Number of Factors to Retain

The following criteria, while considering parsimony (a model with the fewest possible factors) and plausibility (a model that makes theoretical and empirical sense) were used to determine the optimal number of factors to retain in the factor analysis model (Fabrigar, et al., 1999).

1. The Kaiser criterion of selecting factors with eigenvalues greater than one (Gorsuch, 1983).
2. The Cattell's scree test (Cattell, 1966; Cattell & Jaspers, 1967), is generally considered to be more conservative than the Kaiser's criterion. It is a plot of the eigenvalues (and corresponding factors) of the full correlation matrix, and the maximum number of factors is indicated by the point before the plot levels off, that is, the point preceding the elbow. Beyond this point, factors contribute negligible variance. The plot of the eigenvalues of the reduced correlation matrix was also examined, as the focus of this study is on common variance (Fabrigar et al., 1999).

The Initial factors generated by the 54 items were later reduced to 17 items, after consultation with experts along with making other a priori theoretical considerations.

Rotation of Factors

Rotation is a technique for reorienting factor loadings so that they are more interpretable. Mathematically, exploratory factor analysis (EFA) models with more than one factor may not have a

unique solution since there may be an unlimited number of alternative factor orientations in multidimensional space that explain the data as well (Fabrigar et al., 1999). The challenge is thus to choose one solution from among these. The notion of simple structure influenced this element of the investigation (Thurstone, 1947). Thurstone pointed out that in this case, the solution with the best "simple structure" would be the most simply interpretable, psychologically meaningful, and reproducible.

Oblimin Factor rotation was used in the current study since it is expected that psychological constructs will have underlying relationships.

Factor (Subscale) Interpretation and Naming

Following oblimin rotation, each cluster of variables was carefully studied to establish the underlying construct and its substantive meaning, or what the items (in each cluster) share (Kim & Mueller, 1978).

For a sample size of roughly 200, a pattern coefficient ("loading") of .4 or higher (that is, a component explaining at least 16% of an item's variance) was considered salient (Field, 2000; Hair et al., 1998; Stevens, 1992).

Analysis of Reliability

Cronbach's alpha (Cronbach, 1951; Nunnally, 1967) was computed for the overall scale after rotation and preliminary interpretation and labeling of the factors (subscales). Cronbach's alpha assesses the degree of internal consistency (reliability), or how well a group of questions reflects a

single unidimensional latent construct or dimension of a construct (van Os, 2002). In general, a Cronbach's alpha of at least .7 is used to determine an acceptable level of internal consistency (reliability) (Ghiselli, 1981; Nunnally, 1967).

Validation Strategies

Content Validity

Expert reviews may consist of the following: 1) content reviews, which offer feedback on the initial pool of items regarding their accuracy, completeness, and relevance to the content domain; 2) sensitivity reviews, which assess the possibility of item bias; and 3) standard setting, which involves identifying cutoff scores for criterion-referenced decisions on performance levels or diagnostic classifications (Dimitrov, 2012).

The review provides a variety of functions that maximize content validity. When creating a tool with numerous scales to measure different components, the review process is extremely helpful.

A thorough assessment of the relevant literature, as well as interaction with specialists, aided in item production and item analysis. In accordance with best practices (Haynes, Richard, & Kubany, 1995; Nunnally & Bernstein, 1994),

Convergent/discriminant measures for Construct validity

Convergent Validity:

A modified version of the situational rape proclivity scale (Malamuth, 1981) was utilised

for convergent validity. Measures of theoretically similar constructs should be significantly intercorrelated, according to the principle of convergent validity.

Discriminant Validity:

Discriminant validity is established to ascertain the distinctiveness of the constructs in the study. It shows that constructs in the study have their own individual identity and are not too highly correlated with other constructs in the study. Spiritual Transcendence Scale- Short Form(Ralph L. Piedmont, Ph.D., 2003) was used for testing for divergent validity.

Testing for Significance

Statistical significance was evaluated throughout this investigation using an alpha level of.05.

Results and Discussion

Exploratory Factor Analysis of the Seventeen (17) Retained Items

17 items of the Multidimensional Rape Predisposition scale item pool were subjected to principal components analysis (PCA) using JAMOV Version 2.3. Before performing PCA, the suitability of data for factor analysis was assessed. Inspection of the correlation matrix revealed the presence of many coefficients of .3 and above. The Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin value was .75, exceeding the recommended value of .6,^{12, 13} and Bartlett's Test of Sphericity reached statistical significance,¹⁴ supporting the factorability of the correlation matrix.

Principal components analysis revealed the presence of five components with eigenvalues exceeding 1, explaining 22.09%, 13.19%, 11.07%, 8.87%, and 6.59% of the variance, respectively. Further, an inspection of the scree plot (Appendix A) suggested a five-factor model (which accounted for 61.8% of the variance). All the items loaded satisfactorily on five-factors (see Table 1 for factor loadings and descriptives of the 17 items). The 17 items scale showed good reliability with a Cronbach's alpha of .74

Table 3

Initial Eigenvalues and Percent of Variance Explained by Each Component

Component	Eigenvalue	% of Variance	Cumulative %
1	3.755	22.09	22.1
2	2.242	13.19	35.3

3	1.883	11.07	46.4
4	1.509	8.87	55.2
5	1.120	6.59	61.8
6	0.859	5.06	66.9

Figure 5
EFA Scree Plot

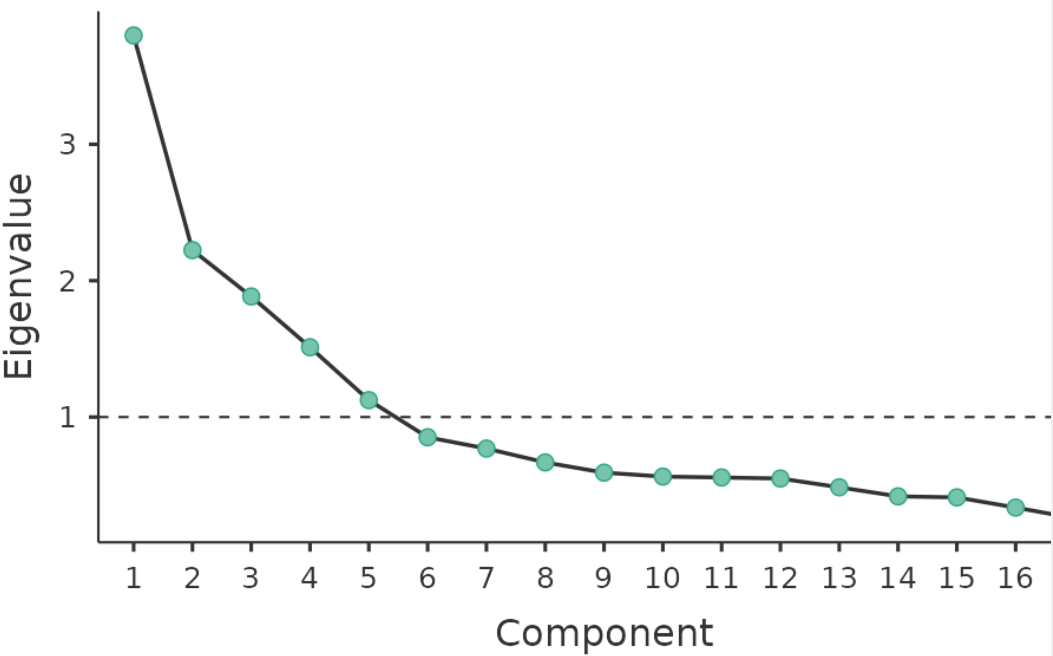


Table 4
Results from a Factor Analysis of the _Multidimensional Rape Predisposition _____
Questionnaire

Q.n	Items	Factor loading
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		1	2	3	4	5
Factor 1: Affective Concern						
13.	I get affected by the emotions of people around me.	.80	.01	.02	.02	.03
11.	My friend's issues affect me emotionally	.77	-.01	-.01	.05	.00
10.	I feel sad when I hurt someone	.74	-.01	-.03	.01	.03
12	I feel hurt when I see injustice	.64	.02	.29	-.18	-.10
Factor 2: Social Functioning						
16.	It is difficult to make deeper connections with people	-.02	.78	.13	-.03	-.13
14.	I feel lonely and isolated	-.06	.77	-.10	-.11	-.00
15.	Other people do not understand me	.00	.75	.16	-.03	.04
17.	It is difficult to find a sexual partner	.10	.67	-.17	.22	.23
Factor 3: Need For Power						
7.	Authority over my sexual partner	.02	.00	.85	.12	.08

	makes me satisfied					
8.	Having authority makes me feel superior to my sexual partner	-.11	.10	.75	.11	.03
9.	It is important that my sexual partner remembers who is in charge	.02	-.02	.67	.17	.09

Factor 4: Responsibility Avoidance

6.	People who do not dress the way they should deserve to face the consequences	.02	-.02	.02	.83	.00
5.	People get raped because of their own behaviour/attitude.	-.04	-.02	.22	.72	-.16
4.	If a person is comfortable sharing a private room with me, I can have sex with them	-.04	.02	.02	.59	.15

Factor 5: Consent Taking

3.	It is okay to convince someone to	.01	-.06	.19	-.19	.77
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	try new things in sex					
1.	It is okay to convince and persuade someone to have sex with me	.08	.06	-.01	.07	.77
2.	If a person is not resisting sex it means that they want to have sex	-.29	-.02	.05	.12	.60

Note. N=162. The extraction method was Principal components with direct oblimin rotation

Interpretation and Naming of the Factors

Items on Factors 1, 3 & 5(Affective Concern, Need For Power, Consent Taking respectively) directly loaded as proposed in the preliminary 54-item scale, consistent with the proposed factors, whereas the Social component of socio-emotive functioning was retained in Factor 2(Social functioning). Factor 4 has been labelled as Responsibility avoidance as these items were part of the Survivor Cause sub-domain which pertains to placing the responsibility of sexual assault on the survivor(Q5.People get raped because of their own behaviour/attitude, Q6 People who do not dress the way they should, deserve to face the consequences), and Not rape sub-domain which denies acquaintance rape (Q4. If a person is comfortable sharing a private room with me, I can have sex with them).

It is important to note that According to National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)Objective

This cross-sectional study was aimed at developing and preliminarily validating a multidimensional psychometric scale extracting literature from multiple models of sexual offending and testing for its applicability in the Indian context.

data, 65,025 rape crimes were registered in India in 2021, with the offenders known to the victims in 96.8 percent of the cases.

Convergent Validity

The correlation matrix showed that there is a positive correlation of 0.278 (significant at $p < .01$) between the MRPS and SRPS ($N=109$). This indicates that there is evidence of convergent validity for the MRPS scale, as it is positively related to the SRPS scale that measures the situational self-reported tendency to rape. The correlation coefficient value of 0.278 suggests a moderate positive relationship between the two scales, indicating that as scores on the SRPS scale increase, scores on the MRPS scale also tend to increase. It is expected that the correlation could be higher since the participants might have exhibited some social desirability bias while self-reporting their offense proclivity.

Discriminant Validity

To assess discriminant validity, we examine the correlations between the measures and look for evidence that they are distinct from each other. Looking at the correlation matrix, it was found that the correlation between MRPS and STS-R is very low (Pearson's $r = 0.038$), and not statistically significant ($p = 0.692$). This suggests that the two measures are not strongly related to each other and provides evidence for discriminant validity.

Discussion

The present study aimed to develop and validate a Multidimensional Rape Predisposition Scale (MRPS) that captures a more comprehensive understanding of rape predisposition among young adults. The scale was constructed based on a theoretical framework that generated five factors: Affective Concern, Social Functioning, Need for Power, Responsibility Avoidance, and Consent Taking. The final 17-item scale demonstrated strong psychometric properties, with good reliability and evidence of convergent and discriminant validity.

The development of the MRPS is an essential contribution to the existing body of research on rape predisposition, as it provides a more nuanced understanding of the various factors that may contribute to an individual's likelihood of engaging in sexually aggressive behavior. Previous research has often focused on single factors, such as attitudes towards women or endorsement of rape myths, which may not capture the complexity of this phenomenon. The MRPS adds to this literature by considering multiple dimensions of rape predisposition, which allows for a more in-depth exploration of the factors that contribute to sexual aggression.

The five factors identified in the MRPS reflect important dimensions of rape predisposition. Affective Concern encompasses empathy and emotional sensitivity, which have been shown to play a role in sexual aggression (Malamuth et al., 1991). Individuals with lower levels of affective concern may be less likely to empathize with their potential victims, increasing the likelihood of engaging in sexually aggressive behavior.

Social Functioning relates to an individual's ability to form and maintain social connections. Prior research has suggested that social isolation and poor social skills may contribute to the development of sexually aggressive behavior . The inclusion of this factor in the MRPS acknowledges the importance of social factors in understanding rape predisposition.

Need for Power reflects an individual's desire for control and dominance in sexual relationships. Research has consistently demonstrated that power imbalances and the need for control are central elements in the perpetration of sexual aggression (Malamuth et al., 1995). The inclusion of this factor in the MRPS highlights the role of power dynamics in sexual aggression.

Responsibility Avoidance captures the tendency to place blame on the victim or external circumstances for sexual assault. This factor is particularly relevant in the context of acquaintance rape, where perpetrators may rationalize their actions by blaming the victim for their behavior or appearance (Wegner et al., 2015). The inclusion of Responsibility Avoidance in the MRPS emphasizes the importance of understanding how cognitive distortions and justifications may contribute to rape predisposition.

Finally, Consent Taking reflects an individual's understanding and adherence to the principles of sexual consent. Research has shown that misperceptions of consent and the use of coercive tactics are common features of sexual aggression. The inclusion of this factor in the MRPS underscores the need for improved education and awareness around sexual consent.

The MRPS demonstrated convergent validity with the Situational Rape Proclivity Scale (SRPS), which measures self-reported situational tendencies to commit rape. The moderate positive

correlation between the two scales suggests that the MRPS captures similar underlying constructs to the SRPS, while also providing a more comprehensive understanding of rape predisposition. It is worth noting that the correlation could be higher, but participants may have exhibited social desirability bias when self-reporting their offense proclivity.

The MRPS also demonstrated discriminant validity when compared to the Spiritual transcendence Scale (STS-R), with a very low and non-significant correlation between the two measures. This indicates that the MRPS is distinct from the STS-R, suggesting that it captures unique aspects of rape predisposition not accounted for by STRS.

Limitations

The present study had some limitations that should be acknowledged. First, the sample consisted primarily of young adults from semi-urban and urban areas, which may limit the generalizability of the findings to other populations or age groups. Future research should aim to include a more diverse sample in terms of age, geographic location, and cultural backgrounds to ensure the applicability of the MRPS across different contexts. Second, the study relied on self-report measures, which may be subject to social desirability bias or inaccurate self-assessment. Future research could benefit from incorporating additional assessment methods, such as behavioral measures or third-party evaluations, to corroborate the self-reported data.

Application & Use Cases

Despite these limitations, the development and validation of the MRPS represent a significant contribution to the literature on rape predisposition. The scale's multidimensional approach allows for a more comprehensive understanding of the factors that contribute to sexual aggression, which can inform the development of targeted prevention and intervention strategies. By identifying specific areas of vulnerability or risk, the MRPS can help guide tailored interventions that address the unique needs of individuals at risk for engaging in sexually aggressive behavior. For example, interventions targeting affective concern might emphasize empathy-building exercises, while those focusing on consent taking could promote education on the principles of sexual consent.

Moreover, the MRPS can be used in both research and applied settings to assess rape predisposition among different populations. In research contexts, the scale can be employed to investigate the relationships between rape predisposition and other variables of interest, such as personality traits, social factors, or mental health outcomes. In applied settings, the MRPS can serve as a valuable screening tool to identify individuals at risk for sexual aggression, allowing for early intervention and support.

Implications of the Results and Specific Recommendations

For future research, it is recommended that confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) be employed to further validate the factor structure of the MRPS. CFA is a statistical technique used to

verify the factor structure of a set of observed variables and is an important step in establishing the robustness and validity of a measurement scale. By aiming to replicate the five-factor model identified in this study and assessing the goodness-of-fit indices, researchers can determine whether the model provides an accurate representation of the underlying factor structure.

Moreover, structural equation modeling (SEM) should be utilized in future research to examine the relationships among the five factors identified in the MRPS, as well as their associations with other relevant variables, such as personality traits, social factors, or mental health outcomes. By allowing for the simultaneous analysis of multiple relationships, SEM provides a more comprehensive understanding of the complex network of factors contributing to rape predisposition. Additionally, SEM can be used to investigate potential mediators or moderators of the relationships between the factors and rape predisposition, further enriching our understanding of the mechanisms underlying sexual aggression.

Future studies should also adopt a longitudinal design to examine the stability of the MRPS factors over time and their potential predictive value in identifying individuals at risk for engaging in sexually aggressive behavior. Longitudinal research can provide valuable insights into the developmental trajectories of rape predisposition and inform the timing and focus of prevention efforts. Furthermore, to enhance the generalizability of the findings, future research should examine the factor structure of the MRPS in diverse populations, including different age groups, cultural backgrounds, and gender identities. This will allow for a more inclusive understanding of rape predisposition and inform the development of culturally sensitive prevention and intervention strategies.

Finally, building on the findings of this study and future research, targeted interventions should be developed and evaluated to address the specific factors identified in the MRPS. Such interventions may include promoting empathy and emotional intelligence (Affective Concern), enhancing social skills and reducing feelings of isolation (Social Functioning), addressing power dynamics and promoting egalitarian relationships (Need for Power), challenging victim-blaming attitudes and cognitive distortions (Responsibility Avoidance), and improving understanding and practice of sexual consent (Consent Taking). By addressing these recommendations in future research, we can deepen our understanding of the complex factors contributing to rape predisposition and strengthen the foundation for evidence-based prevention and intervention efforts aimed at reducing sexual aggression.

Conclusion

This research paper serves as a step towards understanding and addressing the deeply troubling issue of sexual offenses. This study not only contributes to the current literature but also provides a framework for a more comprehensive approach towards identifying risk factors and protective variables.

The inclusion of dynamic factors, treatment outcomes, strengths, and protective variables in the scale will better capture the complexity of human behavior. Moreover, the attempt to be more inclusive in language and the recognition of the LGBTQ community as potential victims is a much-needed step towards promoting inclusivity and protection.

It is critical to note that the purpose of this scale is not to label individuals as potential perpetrators but to identify factors that increase their likelihood of making sexually offensive choices. It is hoped that this study will aid in developing interventions that protect potential victims and perpetrators alike from the consequences of such acts.

As we conclude, it is essential to acknowledge that sexual offenses are heinous crimes that have far-reaching consequences. The victims of sexual offenses often suffer not only physical but also psychological and emotional trauma. It is our collective responsibility to work towards creating a society where everyone feels safe and secure. This research is a small yet significant step towards that goal, and we hope that it serves as a catalyst for further research in this field.

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APPENDIX A

Content Validation form for Multidimensional Rape Predisposition Scale (54 items)

Items

Dear experts, The following scale contains 54 items under 6 domains, with 9 items under each domain. Your expert judgement is required to gauge the relevance of each item that appears on the scale.

In front of each Item, it is expected to rate them as constructively as possible, based on the criteria given below-

- 1- The Item is not relevant to the measured domain
- 2- The item is somewhat relevant to the measured domain
- 3- The item is quite relevant to the measured domain
- 4- The item is Highly relevant to the measured domain

Note- (R) stands for reverse-coded items.

Consent (Freely given, Reversible, Enthusiastic, Specific)

Consent is an unequivocal voluntary agreement when a person communicates a willingness to engage in a specific sexual act through words, gestures, or any other means of verbal or nonverbal communication.

Items	1	2	3	4
1. It is okay to convince and persuade someone to have sex with me (FG)				
2. A person can change their mind after agreeing to have sex (R) (Re)				
3. Consent is not needed if I had sex with the person before (Re)				
4. Conversations are not important during sex (Sp)				
5. I like a particular sex act and I assume the other person will also like it (Sp)				
6. If a person likes having sex, they will like it with me (En)				
7. If a person is making out with me it means they want to have sex (Sp)				
8. If a person is not resisting sex it means that they want to have sex (FG)				
9. It is okay to convince someone to try new things in sex (En)				

Rape myth Acceptance(Not rape, Survivor cause, Alcohol, transphobia & Misogyny, Gender role).

Rape Myths are collective sets of attitudes and ideas that are rape tolerant and supportive.

- Not Rape - denial that acquaintance rape is real and causes trauma to the victim)
- Survivor Cause -Placing the responsibility of sexual assault on the survivor
- Alcohol- problematic attitudes and beliefs about mixing alcohol use and sexual activity.
- Transphobia & misogyny- general hostility faced by transgender individuals and women
- Gender role -Acceptance of traditional male and female gender roles.

Items	1	2	3	4
1. If a person is comfortable sharing a private room with me, I can have sex with them (NR)				
2. Rapists are always strangers (NR)				
3. People get raped because of their own behaviour/attitude. (SC)				
4. People who do not dress the way they should, deserve to face the consequences (SC)				
5. It is wrong to have sex with someone when they are drunk, even if the person is someone you know. (R) (A)				

6. If someone goes to places like bars and pubs a lot, it shows that the person is sexually available. (A)				
7. I get uncomfortable around people I cannot identify as a male or a female (TM)				
8. If a person shows interest in me, then what happens next is not my responsibility (SC)				
9. Being sexually active is a sign of masculinity				

Need For Power

The need for power is a form of motivation that stems from the want to dominate others and have influence.

Items	1	2	3	4
1. Authority over my sexual partner makes me satisfied				
2. Having authority makes me feel superior to my sexual partner				
3. You can only gain respect when you have power				

4. My sexual partner and I both have an equal say in a decision (R)				
5. As long as I am in charge, things are easier in my relationship				
6. It is important that my sexual partner remembers who is in charge				
7. I do not like it when I get told to do things				
8. Males should be in an authority position when having sex				
9. Using force during sex gives me satisfaction				

Empathic Concern

Empathetic Concern is the feeling of warmth, compassion and concern for another individual, which allows us to care for other individuals and extend our sense of self towards them.

Items	1	2	3	4
1. I feel sad when I hurt someone (R)				
2. People tell me that I understand their feelings (R)				

3. I am able to understand when someone is uncomfortable (R)				
4. I get affected by the emotions of people around me. (R)				
5. If I am on a bus and the person sitting next to me is crying, I would not care.				
6. I feel hurt when I see injustice (R)				
7. I do not care how my behaviour makes others feel				
8. My friend's issues affect me emotionally (R)				
9. I mind my own business even if I know someone is being wronged				

Immediate Gratification (Food, Money, Physical, Achievement - adapted from DGI, Hoerger, 2011)

Immediate Gratification is the need to attain satisfaction, be it of a very small degree, in a very short span of time without any want of delaying the satisfaction for any other goal that does not directly and immediately satiate the individual.

Items	1	2	3	4
1. I feel hard work pays off at the end (R)				
2. I am not good at saving money				
3. I eat junk food even when I am trying to avoid it				
4. In school, I liked taking the easier way out				
5. I tend to get bored				
6. I can give up on physical pleasures for long-term goals (R)				
7. I engage in risky activities for the thrill of it				
8. I feel sex is as necessary as food and should not be delayed				
9. I need to know someone before having sex with them (R)				

Socio-Emotional Functioning (Emotional dysregulation, Social functioning)

It is the degree to which an individual is able to regulate their emotions in personal and social contexts and is able to interact with other individuals in a secure and functional manner.

Items	1	2	3	4
1. It is difficult for me to concentrate when I am upset (ED)				
2. I feel out of control when I am upset (ED)				
3. When I feel upset, I take my time to understand the cause (ED) (R)				
4. I feel ashamed when I am upset about something (ED)				
5. I have good relationships with my family and relatives (SF) (R)				
6. I feel lonely and isolated (SF)				
7. Other people do not understand me (SF)				
8. It is difficult to make deeper connections with people (SF)				
9. It is difficult to find a sexual partner (SF)				

Validation Sheet

Name of Validator:

Degree:

Position:

Years of Experience:

Scale: 5- Excellent; 4- Very Good; 3- Good; 2- Fair, 1- Poor

	5	4	3	2	1
1. Clarity and Direction of items The vocabulary level, language, structure and conceptual level of participants. The test items are clear and understandable.					
2. Suitability of items The questions are designed to determine the construct supposed to be measured.					
3. Adequateness of the content The number of questions per area is representative enough of all questions needed for the research.					
4. Attainment of purpose The instrument as a whole fulfils the objectives needed for the research.					
5. Objective Each Item question requires only one specific answer or measures only one behaviour.					

6. Scale and evaluation Rating The scale adopted is appropriate for the item					
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REMARKS:

SIGNATURE

APPENDIX B**Siritual Transcendence Scale- Short Form**

Items	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
1. In the quiet of my prayers and /or meditations, I find a sense of wholeness.					
2. I have done things in my life because I believed it would please a parent, relative, or friend that had died.					
3. Although dead, memories and thoughts of some of my relatives continue to influence my current life.					
4. I find inner strength and/or peace from my prayers and/or					

meditations.

5. I do not have any strong emotional ties to someone who has died.

6. There is no higher plane of consciousness or spirituality that binds all people.

7. Although individual people may be difficult, I feel an emotional bond with all of humanity.

8. My prayers and/or meditations provide me with a sense of emotional support.

9. I feel that on a higher level all of us share a common bond.

Appendix C

Situational Rape Proclivity Scale

Instructions: Please indicate how likely you may be to have sex with a person *against* their wishes (provided that you were assured you could get away with it without penalty or consequence) in the following situations, where-

- 1- Very Likely
- 2- Fairly Likely
- 3- Possible, but not likely
- 4- Not at all Likely

1. You are alone with a female acquaintance whom you have known for years.
2. You are walking alone through the woods and come across an attractive woman walking by herself
3. You are alone with an attractive woman whom you have met at an out-of-town party, whom you are not likely to see again
4. You are alone with a woman who you met at a party, and who is in your room—passed out drunk.

5. You are alone with a woman who has been —leading-you-on to believe that she would have sex with you, but then said —no.
6. You are alone with a woman who is a known —tease.